

Retrieval Augmented Generation

Project: Verified Study Buddy

1. Retrieval-Augmented Generation

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of building a grounded answer

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Model Memory vs Retrieval

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Model Memory vs Retrieval. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of retrieval and indexing

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Retrieval returns stored records selected for a query. An index is a searchable representation of a versioned corpus; generated wording is a later operation. Assign stable document IDs, versions and permitted access before indexing. Retrieve only authorised records. Preserve source references and define behaviour when a document is missing, outdated or access-restricted.

Source Quality

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Source Quality. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of conflicting and time-sensitive sources

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Changing facts require a stated time and source-version policy. Current-looking records can conflict without enough evidence to choose between them. For this toy task a signed amendment supersedes the referenced original from its effective time. Keep both records. A newer timestamp alone has no authority unless the policy grants it.

Speech and Audio Systems

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Speech and Audio Systems. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of speech pipelines and multimodal evidence

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A multimodal pipeline may transcribe speech, inspect an image and generate a response. Errors at one stage can propagate even when later stages run correctly. Track source modality, segment/time references, transcription, interpretation and final claims separately. Compare conflicting evidence without assuming one modality always wins. Ask for clarification when the task needs unresolved information.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

Sources: A='Library opens 9'; B='Cafe opens 8'; C='Library closes 5'. A question asks when the library opens. The retriever returns only B and C. What should the generator do?

Concept to explain

Term · Meaning

Term: query

Meaning: A question or search request used to obtain information.

Term: retriever

Meaning: The component that searches for and selects source material relevant to a query.

Term: relevance

Meaning: How directly information helps answer the stated question or perform the task.

Term: grounded answer

Meaning: An answer whose factual claims are supported by identified evidence relevant to the question.

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Two 45-minute sessions. A grounded answer connects each factual claim to evidence actually retrieved for the task. Retrieval success does not automatically make generation faithful. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Readiness answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

Apply the connected idea: Chunking and document structure

Two 45-minute sessions. Chunking divides documents into retrievable units. A useful chunk retains enough structure to interpret a passage, including headers and exceptions. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Readiness answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

Apply the connected idea: Lexical and vector retrieval

Two 45-minute sessions. Lexical retrieval matches terms; vector retrieval compares numerical representations. Each can fail when the representation misses the relevant distinction. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Readiness answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain retrieval augmented generation using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain the mechanism

Explain the mechanism

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

1. Question is converted into a search query.
2. Retriever returns four passages; selector keeps two relevant ones.
3. Generator answers using those passages and attaches citations.
4. If retrieval misses the needed evidence, generation should ask, search again, or abstain.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

Concrete teaching case

Note A says library opens at 9. Note B says returns go in the blue box.

Answer opening time with evidence.

Exact explanation to model

Answer 9 with note A. Retrieval supplies evidence and generation phrases it. B does not support opening time.

Explain the added worked example

A grounded answer connects each factual claim to evidence actually retrieved for the task. Retrieval success does not automatically make generation faithful.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Build a claim-evidence table before final wording. Preserve source versions and qualifiers, omit unsupported claims or explicitly state the gap, then validate the answer against the table.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Key terms

Term · Meaning

Term: Grounded claim

Meaning: A claim supported by the available task evidence

Term: Qualifier

Meaning: A condition restricting a statement

Term: Evidence table

Meaning: A mapping from each claim to its supporting record

Apply the connected idea: Chunking and document structure

Chunking divides documents into retrievable units. A useful chunk retains enough structure to interpret a passage, including headers and exceptions.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Give each chunk its document/version ID, section and offsets. Preserve qualifiers or link adjacent material. Overlap can repeat information; repeated chunks are not independent sources.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Guided: The first chunk alone lacks the applicable exception. Retrieve the linked condition and determine maintenance status before asserting capacity 20. Qualification: Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Apply the connected idea: Lexical and vector retrieval

Lexical retrieval matches terms; vector retrieval compares numerical representations. Each can fail when the representation misses the relevant distinction.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already

supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

For a toy lexical score, count distinct query terms present after lowercase exact-word matching. For a toy vector score use a stated dot product. Compare relevance using independent judgments, not score magnitude alone.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Guided: Lexical ranks D1 first; dot product ranks D2 first (.8 versus .4). The supplied task relevance favours the sensor manual; vector ranking alone does not prove relevance. Qualification: Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Current source P approves room C; Q lists C capacity 10. Draft says room C is approved, seats 10 and offers lunch.

Approval and capacity are supported by P and Q; lunch lacks evidence. A grounded answer reports the first two claims and does not invent lunch.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Retrieval Augmented Generation

Turn a short science source into an answer with a visible claim-to-source map.

The facts we will use

Approved note S4 says: ice is solid water; warming can melt ice into liquid water. No temperature or speed is supplied.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

Retrieval Augmented Generation

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Read source

S4 supports the material identity and the solid-to-liquid change.



2. Draft two claims

Draft: ice is solid water; warming can turn it into liquid water.



3. Check each claim

Both claims match S4. A claim that melting takes exactly two minutes would not match.

CHANGE ONE THING

The question asks exactly how long this ice takes to melt.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Read source

What happens and why: S4 supports the material identity and the solid-to-liquid change.

Step: 2. Draft two claims

What happens and why: Draft: ice is solid water; warming can turn it into liquid water.

Step: 3. Check each claim

What happens and why: Both claims match S4. A claim that melting takes exactly two minutes would not match.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Read the picture in order. Both claims match S4. A claim that melting takes exactly two minutes would not match. The arrows show which recorded input or intermediate result each decision uses. Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows.

What this example does not establish

This source-grounding exercise does not establish that every source is complete or scientifically authoritative.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: The question asks exactly how long this ice takes to melt.

Prediction: Say that S4 does not provide a time.

Reason: A general change of state does not determine a duration for an unspecified sample.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: Note A says library opens at 9. Note B says returns go in the blue box.

Write the question to explain: Answer opening time with evidence.

Reveal after predictions: Answer 9 with note A. Retrieval supplies evidence and generation phrases it. B does not support opening time.

Keep for an independent attempt: A retrieved passage says the club meets Tuesday; it says nothing about cost. The assistant answers Tuesday, free entry. Which part is grounded and what should replace the

unsupported part?

Classroom dialogue

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks evidence; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

Guided: Approval and capacity are supported by P and Q; lunch lacks evidence. A grounded answer reports the first two claims and does not invent lunch. **Qualification:** Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient. **Exit:** accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

Stage: Session 1: 0–7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.

Stage: 7–18 minutes

Teacher action: Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.

Stage: 18–32 minutes

Teacher action: Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.

Stage: 32–45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.

Stage: Session 2: 0–8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.

Stage: 8–20 minutes

Teacher action: Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.

Stage: 20–35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Teach the connected idea

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Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Teach the connected idea

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Stage: Session 1: 0–7 minutes

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Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Current source P approves room C; Q lists C capacity 10. Draft says room C is approved, seats 10 and offers lunch. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Approval and capacity are supported by P and Q; lunch lacks evidence. A grounded answer reports the first two claims and does not invent lunch.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Building a grounded answer. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Connected teaching cycle: Chunking and document structure

Target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of chunking and document structure

Reserve further sessions for this topic; the 135-minute primary plan does not absorb all added content.

Completion practice: A notice says capacity 20, followed by during maintenance capacity 8. Separate chunks contain each sentence but retrieval returns only the first. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: The first chunk alone lacks the applicable exception. Retrieve the linked condition and determine maintenance status before asserting capacity 20.

Individual check: For Chunking and document structure, use its worked case to evaluate this proposed explanation: "The worked result establishes every future case". Explain the deciding step.

Expected correction: Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality.

Apply the same support, independent transfer and delayed-review decisions to the named connected-topic workbook tasks.

Connected teaching cycle: Lexical and vector retrieval

Target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of lexical and vector retrieval

Reserve further sessions for this topic; the 135-minute primary plan does not absorb all added content.

Completion practice: Query terms red sensor. D1 text red sensor manual; D2 text red paint. Their lexical scores are 2 and 1. Vector query $[1, 0]$, $D1=[.4, .9]$, $D2=[.8, .1]$. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Lexical ranks D1 first; dot product ranks D2 first (.8 versus .4). The supplied task relevance favours the sensor manual; vector ranking alone does not prove relevance.

Individual check: For Lexical and vector retrieval, use its worked case to evaluate this proposed explanation: "The worked result establishes every future case". Explain the deciding step.

Expected correction: Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary.

Apply the same support, independent transfer and delayed-review decisions to the named connected-topic workbook tasks.

Pictorial practice question

Which part of the source supports a two-minute melting claim? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

None. Keep the supported state-change explanation and explicitly say the time is not supplied. Changed-case check: Say that S4 does not provide a time. A general change of state does not determine a duration for an unspecified sample.

Changed-case reasoning: Say that S4 does not provide a time. A general change of state does not

determine a duration for an unspecified sample.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the weekly evidence lab

Run the weekly evidence lab

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.

Run paper RAG with mixed passages, rank relevance, draft only from selected evidence, cite, and test a missing-answer case.

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing. Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record · What to capture

Record: Input or evidence

What to capture: Exact data, instruction or claim

Record: Expected result

What to capture: Answer or safe fallback declared before the run

Record: Observed result

What to capture: Actual result, including errors

Record: Explanation

What to capture: Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome

Record: Next test

What to capture: One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation. Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Check these misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Check these misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

Answer 9 with note A. Retrieval supplies evidence and generation phrases it. B does not support opening time.

Independent question

A retrieved passage says the club meets Tuesday; it says nothing about cost. The assistant answers Tuesday, free entry. Which part is grounded and what should replace the unsupported part?

Expected independent answer

Tuesday is supported. Free entry is unsupported; say the passage does not state the cost and seek an appropriate source if needed.

What counts as evidence

Criterion · 0 points · 1 point · 2 points

Criterion: Result

0 points: Incorrect or absent

1 point: Partly correct

2 points: Correct with necessary conditions

Criterion: Reasoning

0 points: No supporting trace

1 point: Some steps

2 points: Clear mechanism, calculation or source support

Criterion: Limit

0 points: Overclaims certainty

1 point: Vague limitation

2 points: Relevant uncertainty or missing fact

Criterion: Transfer

0 points: Copies without adapting

1 point: Adapts with prompts

2 points: Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold. Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the evidence that challenges this claim: “Retrieving one useful passage supports every detail in the final answer.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

It should say the supplied retrieved sources do not establish opening time and request better retrieval. The full collection contains A, so diagnose retrieval separately from generation. A generator should not use cafe hours as library evidence.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: A grounded answer connects each factual claim to evidence actually retrieved for the task. Retrieval success does not automatically make generation faithful. Build a claim-evidence table before final wording. Preserve source versions and qualifiers, omit unsupported claims or explicitly state the gap, then validate the answer against the table.

W2 Trace the worked case

Current source P approves room C; Q lists C capacity 10. Draft says room C is approved, seats 10 and offers lunch. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: Approval and capacity are supported by P and Q; lunch lacks evidence. A grounded answer reports the first two claims and does not invent lunch.

W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Source A approves room H; B lists H capacity 7, except maintenance limit 4. Maintenance status is unknown. Write a grounded response.

Teacher explanation: Room H approval is supported. State the conditional capacities 7 normally and 4 during maintenance, with status unresolved; do not choose an unconditional capacity.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. Grounding requires support for the exact claim, including conditions; attaching a source name is insufficient. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Chunking and document structure — W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Chunking divides documents into retrievable units. A useful chunk retains enough structure to interpret a passage, including headers and exceptions. Give each chunk its document/version ID, section and offsets. Preserve qualifiers or link adjacent material. Overlap can repeat information; repeated chunks are not independent sources.

Chunking and document structure — W2 Trace the worked case

A notice says capacity 20, followed by during maintenance capacity 8. Separate chunks contain each sentence but retrieval returns only the first. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: The first chunk alone lacks the applicable exception. Retrieve the linked condition and determine maintenance status before asserting capacity 20.

Chunking and document structure — W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

Chunking and document structure — W4 Apply a new case independently

A rule section says rooms close at 17:00; an exception paragraph says Friday closes at 16:00. The question is Friday closing. Design a complete chunk reference.

Teacher explanation: Return both rule and linked Friday exception with document/version and section references; answer 16:00 from the exception. An isolated 17:00 chunk is insufficient.

Chunking and document structure — W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. Smaller chunks can improve selectivity while losing necessary qualifiers; chunk size alone is not retrieval quality. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Lexical and vector retrieval — W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Lexical retrieval matches terms; vector retrieval compares numerical representations. Each can fail when the representation misses the relevant distinction. For a toy lexical score, count distinct query terms present after lowercase exact-word matching. For a toy vector score use a stated dot product. Compare relevance using independent judgments, not score magnitude alone.

Lexical and vector retrieval — W2 Trace the worked case

Query terms red sensor. D1 text red sensor manual; D2 text red paint. Their lexical scores are 2 and 1. Vector query [1, 0], D1=[.4, .9], D2=[.8, .1]. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: Lexical ranks D1 first; dot product ranks D2 first (.8 versus .4). The supplied task relevance favours the sensor manual; vector ranking alone does not prove relevance.

Lexical and vector retrieval — W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

Lexical and vector retrieval — W4 Apply a new case independently

Query terms blue battery. E1 text blue battery guide, vector [.2, .8]; E2 text blue ribbon, vector [.9, .1]. Query vector [1, 0]. Compute both rankings.

Teacher explanation: Lexical E1=2, E2=1; vector E1=.2, E2=.9 so rankings disagree. Check relevance for the battery task; do not equate dot product with source truth.

Lexical and vector retrieval — W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. Similarity and relevance are different quantities; exact terminology, metadata and permissions may be necessary. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Source A approves room H; B lists H capacity 7, except maintenance limit 4. Maintenance status is unknown. Write a grounded response.

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: Room H approval is supported. State the conditional capacities 7 normally and 4 during maintenance, with status unresolved; do not choose an unconditional capacity.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect and extend learning

Connect and extend learning

Verified Study Buddy

Implement question → retrieve → inspect → answer → cite → verify as the core architecture.

Keep the decision, input, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project evidence record.

Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Provide one short approved passage; separate instruction, input, output and evidence. Stretch: introduce an unsupported claim or conflicting source and validate claim by claim with a fallback.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more evidence or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 19: User, Need, and AI Contribution. Retrieve today's evidence and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

W4: Room H approval is supported. State the conditional capacities 7 normally and 4 during maintenance, with status unresolved; do not choose an unconditional capacity. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: Source approves J; register says capacity 9 unless exam setup limits it to 6. Setup unknown. Expected reasoning: Report approval and both capacity conditions; ask which setup applies before giving a single applicable limit. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Next connection: Claim support and citation evaluation. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its evidence boundary before moving on.

Readiness and reassessment for Chunking and document structure

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

W4: Return both rule and linked Friday exception with document/version and section references; answer 16:00 from the exception. An isolated 17:00 chunk is insufficient. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: General limit 30; exam-week exception 18. Question concerns exam week.

Expected reasoning: Preserve both scope and exception; applicable limit 18. Two overlapping chunks do not count as two corroborating sources. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Readiness and reassessment for Lexical and vector retrieval

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

W4: Lexical $E1=2$, $E2=1$; vector $E1=.2$, $E2=.9$ so rankings disagree. Check relevance for the battery task; do not equate dot product with source truth. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: Query green motor; F1 contains both, vector $[.3, .7]$; F2 green fabric, vector $[.6, .4]$; query $[1, 0]$. Expected reasoning: Lexical $F1=2$, $F2=1$; dot products $.3$, $.6$ favour F2. Use relevance judgments to evaluate the representation. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-3/19, ai-3/21, ai-3/24. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Verified Study Buddy, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.